

BERNERA NEWS

In association with **The Daily Ceilidh**

How a small group of friends used the free time afforded to them by lockdown.

At the very start of lockdown, as work seized up and we appeared to have an abundance of time, we spoke about what we might be able to do. We wanted a project that we could invest our time in, but that we hoped would be of some use or interest to the community at large. Being as a great deal of our joint expertise is in putting together websites, and in online media, we began with that. The Daily Ceilidh came into being, in the hope that we might help further links between the two communities of Uig and Bernera. However, we were always very aware that not everyone has access to the internet and the technology required, and many people do not use websites on a regular basis. Our hope, therefore, was to produce a regular community newsletter, where information could be shared, stories could be told, and a little time might be filled for those staying at home during this difficult time. And so the Bernera News was born. Since that first publication, offers of help, support, and contributions have come from far and wide, and the Bernera News continues to grow.

We currently receive no funding, and have produced both the website and the newsletters at our own cost. Luckily, we have some great equipment, including an excellent printer, thanks to Nat and Julia's business. Our costs are therefore kept to an absolute minimum.

Going forward we would like to continue to produce the Bernera News on a regular basis, available to all who want to receive it, at no cost. We are in the process of putting together our plans as to how we might be able to do this and hope to update you in the near future. In the meantime, with so much help and support, we'll continue to produce and self-print a newsletter every other week.

The Bernera News is available on our website www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk for those of you who have access to the internet, including past issues. There's also more Postcards from the Islands, the special lockdown issues of the Uig News, as well as information and news relating to our local community.

If you would prefer to access the Bernera News online, or perhaps just don't want to receive a copy at all, please do let us know and we can take you off our delivery list. Otherwise, we will continue to deliver to every house in Bernera and Tir Mor, thanks to a fantastic team of volunteers. (If you'd like to help out with delivering please get in touch, the more people we have delivering, the easier it becomes.)

We also want to remind you all that anyone can contribute to the Bernera News. We'd very much like to work with all organisations, groups, and businesses within the local community to help share information. We'd also love to hear from anyone who wishes to share something, or perhaps to raise an idea of what you'd like us to feature. The Bernera News is intended as a community publication, and we want as many of you as possible to be involved and to feel that you can contribute and have your say. So please don't hesitate to get in touch.



Julia, Nat, Sam, and Virginia.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159 hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at: www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

SHOP NEWS

The shop continues to make deliveries within the community to those unable to get out and about, as well as maintaining a good stock of goods for all customers. **Opening times 12 - 5 Mon to Sat, and 1 - 3 (shop only) on Sun. (01851) 612282**

BERNERA DOCTOR'S SURGERY

The surgery remains closed, with all medical advice and support through Langabhat Medical Practice. Please ensure you allow at least 72 hours for all prescription requests. The excellent team from Bernera Community Association continue to deliver all prescriptions within our community. **(01851) 860222.**

BUS SERVICE

The bus service continues to be available for key workers only. Bookings have to be made through the Comhairle, and it is to be remembered that the usual bus timetable is not being adhered to at this time. Anyone using the bus service is asked to wear a face mask / covering whilst on board. It is hoped that in the next phase of lockdown further journeys will be permitted, but there is not yet confirmation of what this will mean, and how it will work. We hope to have further details in our next newsletter.

FOOD BANK AND FOOD BOXES

The Salvation Army continues to offer a food bank service at Stornoway Golf Club every Wednesday and Saturday, from 11am to 2pm.

Food boxes are available to anyone within our community.

Contact the Bernera Community Council berneracomcouncil@gmail.com or call Joan Macaulay on (01851) 612309.



BERNERA CAFE

A new business venture has started up in Bernera. The Bernera Café opened on Friday 5th June to provide a limited take-away service on a pre-order basis. They will be open every Friday from 5pm to 8pm over the next few weeks. For the time being, their home-cooked meals are at a subsidised price thanks to Bernera Community Association.

The menu will be advertised on Facebook each week. Alternatively, Please call **07762 128 108** from Wednesday onwards to check the menu. Orders need to be in by 5pm on Thursday. You can place an order either by phone, text, or whatsapp to **07762 128 108**.

Please visit the Bernera Café facebook Page for more information. **facebook.com/berneracafe/**

Keep an eye out for our next issue where we have an "on the sofa" conversation with Gez from the Bernera Café.

CORONAVIRUS UPDATE



Support for anyone in the Outer Hebrides who requires assistance whilst self-isolating is being led by Comhairle nan Eilean Siar.

Call the Community Support Hub & Helpline: 01851 600 501

We're now a week into Phase 2 of the easing of the lockdown situation. I know we're still a long way off what any of us may term "normal life", but hopefully we're all starting to see small, welcome, changes to our lives. A new case on the island has no doubt made many people worry, but it is hoped that this is an isolated case.

It is, however, a reminder that we must continue to act responsibly and in accordance with government advice, no matter how frustrating and difficult we find it. We should continue to wash our hands properly, and regularly, and continue to maintain social distancing at all times with anyone from outside our own households. For anyone wanting more information a local Covid-19 health

concerns helpline is available **Monday to Friday 9am - 5.30pm on (01851) 601 151**. For those requiring urgent medical advice out of hours NHS24 should be called on 111. **In an emergency, always call 999.**

MRS CHRISSIE MACDONALD

The news of the passing of Mrs Chrissie Macdonald, at Harris House, Tarbert, on Sunday, May 24th, was heard with sadness by all who knew her.

At this sad time, we extend the sympathy of the local community to her 2 sons, Angus and Iain Murdo, and their families. Chrissie, nee Macleod, [better known as Chrissie an Ilich] who was 93 last October, was from 8 Geshader, and was the wife of the late Angus Macdonald, 13 Breaclete, Bernera, where their home, Lochside, was a haven of Christian hospitality through the years. She was a lady who was well known throughout the island of Lewis for her Christian walk in life, having come to faith in the island-wide revival of the early fifties. She was very much missed from Breaclete when increasing frailty meant leaving her home and going into Harris House, to be near her son, Rev. Iain Murdo and his family, and where she was lovingly cared for by the staff during her remaining years.

Her funeral, which in more normal times, would have been in church and very largely attended, took place, very quietly, to Bosta Cemetery, and was remarkable for the way in which the community paid their last respects, by standing respectfully by the roadside as the cortege passed. A sign of the times, indeed!

Anna Mackinnon
Uig



BERNERA BAKES... OATCAKES

Careen MacLennan lives in Kirkibost with her husband Murdo and son Donald. She will be sharing recipes once a month in her feature, Bernera Bakes. This is a great opportunity to share her own recipes and the favourites that community members share with her.

Send in your recipes to hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk and help her to make this feature a great community resource!

INGREDIENTS

10oz oatmeal
6oz SR flour
6oz margarine
1oz soft brown sugar
½ teaspoon bicarbonate of soda

METHOD

Pre-heat oven to 180°C.
Cream margarine and sugar together.
Add all dry ingredients.
Knead until all ingredients are combined
Roll out ½ inch thick, cut into rounds.
Bake at 180°C for 25 mins or until golden brown.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



ALPHABET QUIZ

Well done to all those who had a go at the first half of the alphabet quiz last edition. Big thanks to Colin Halliday for putting it together for us. Here are the answers to those questions, as well as the second half of questions for some further pondering.

Answers from Issue #2:

A. Alexander	H. Herring
B. Beast	I. Icarus
C. Clarence	J. Jordan
D. Domesday Book	K. Krakatoa
E. Eden Project	L. Little Big Horn
F. Formaldehyde	M. Minch
G. Gay Gordons	

All answers begin with the letter of the question:

N.	St Andrews day is in
O.	Tectonic plates under water
P.	King Tut was not buried in one, other kings were
Q.	Four wheeled "motor cyle"
R.	Tufty is one
S.	Women who fought for the vote
T.	Name used for a British Soldier
U.	Scottish band who sang about Vienna
V.	A DCI played by Brenda Blethyn
W.	This London palace was once a royal one
X.	Manufacturers of photocopiers and the like
Y.	The first man in space
Z.	Michael Caine's African war film

(answers in the next edition)

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



THE OPENING OF THE BRIDGE, THROUGH THE EYES OF A 10 YEAR OLD.

I'll never forget the feeling of excitement on the morning of Wednesday 22nd July 1953. Today was the day that Bernera was no longer going to be an island, it was finally linked to the mainland by a beautiful white bridge, the first of its kind in the whole of Europe. The bridge was to be opened by the oldest lady in the Island, she was 100 years of age and to me she seemed ancient.

The day before, the Hall and the School Canteen had been readied for all the people coming to see this amazing occasion. As a child and a local, we were told that all visitors had to be served before us, this had always been the way we were brought up, visitors always came first. This still continues in our family today, it's referred to as FHB 'Family Hold Back' which happens at every event in the hall!

The ribbon was cut on the 'mainland' side of the bridge and we were on the Bernera side welcoming all the people to our lovely island. The first thing across the bridge was a car which carried Mrs Macdonald who had cut the ribbon, she was escorted by her son who was the Bernera and Uig councillor at that time. The next across were two pipe bands followed by our Bernera Beauty Queens, after that the remaining visitors crossed the bridge.

I clearly remember skipping along behind the pipe band with my friends, Chrissie & Peter Cameron, all the way to the hall. Everyone was fed in the canteen while we spent our time playing with new found friends who'd come with their parents. In the evening there was a dance in the Hall that went on until the small hours and we were so sad we weren't allowed to go. I will never forget the day as it was the most exciting thing that had happened in my life up until then.



Me, aged 10, with my brother Raymond, aged 5

There was an estimated 2000-4000 people that day and the following week the Stornoway Gazette published a story about it, in it they said, 'On that day, Bernera ceased to be an island and became part of Lewis. Or perhaps it would be more accurate to say Lewis ceased to be an island and became part of Bernera.'

Catriona Davis
Breacleite



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLAND...



"Wherever you can help, your NHS needs you"

Back in March this year, I sent a tentative email to the Western Isles Hospital offering to return to work to help out regular staff who were preparing for a Covid-19 influx to the hospital. At the end of last month, I fronted up for my first Orientation shift at the hospital with my new uniform and new shoes. It was great to be back – the staff were welcoming and brought back that old feeling of camaraderie that many nurses feel. I also had a chance to practise my Beginner Gaelic with many of the patients kindly trying to understand my halting attempts.

Virginia Allum, Earshader

Hello, this is Sam speaking here. I'm making the biggest marble maze in the world, it might even go into the Guinness Book of Records! I like to play with my family, or going looking for crabs. Don't be lonely because of the lockdown, you should do something that you really like that makes you feel happy. Not all people have marble mazes but you probably have other toys you can play with. You might even feel cheerful reading this sentence. And finally, what wobbles in the sky? A jellycopter.

Lots of love, Sam, 5, Kirkibost.



YOUR LOCAL PHARMACIST SAYS.....

Katie has been a qualified Pharmacist for over 10 years and became an Advanced Practitioner Pharmacist in 2016. She currently works for Boots in Stornoway and is a member of the Royal Pharmaceutical Society of Great Britain. She has lived in Kirkibost for over 2 years with her Postman/Fireman Husband, Richard and is hoping to share some of her knowledge in bitesize chunks to keep our Bernera residents as healthy as possible.

"Information about our health is available from many different resources, from newspapers to the internet, and it's hard to know which information is accurate, relevant and reliable these days, so I'm here to help! Please remember that many over-the-counter medicines and supplements can interact with regular prescription medication, so always ask your Pharmacist if it's safe for you to take. This week I'm sharing some advice about Vitamin D supplements."

VITAMIN D

In Scotland it is important that people maintain sufficient levels of vitamin D. Since our main source of vitamin D is sunlight, this advice is especially important for people who are indoors much, or all of the time.

Everyone (including children) should consider taking a daily supplement containing 10 micrograms of vitamin D.

It is specifically recommended that groups at higher risk of vitamin D deficiency take a daily supplement. These groups include:
all pregnant and breastfeeding women, infants and children under 5 years old, people who have low or no exposure to the sun, for example those who cover their skin for cultural reasons, are housebound,



confined indoors for long periods or live in an institution such as a care home and people from minority

ethnic groups with dark skin such as those of African, African-Caribbean and South Asian origin, who require more sun exposure to make as much vitamin D.

Please remember that staying in the sun for prolonged periods without the protection of sunscreen increases the risk of skin cancer.

Vitamin D supplements are available to buy from Pharmacies in Stornoway or online.

Advice taken from the Scottish Government Website 11/6/2020

Katie Booth
Kirkibost



MIND THE VERGES...

We have been asked by a few members of the local community to raise the issue of dog waste, and the dangers associated with not picking up after our animals.

Under the Dog Fouling (Scotland) Act 2003 you are guilty of an offence if you fail to remove your dog's faeces from a public place and dispose of it properly. This includes areas such as verges and pathways, as well as beaches.

Dog waste can carry potentially dangerous diseases which, although rare, can cause severe problems to human health. Parasites found in some dog faeces can also result in the abortions of cattle and death in sheep. NFU Scotland therefore urge members of the public to also clean up after their dogs when walking in places where these animals are present, including on croft land and common grazings.

Discarded waste-filled bags also carry a significant threat to livestock and other wildlife, so please ensure that any collected waste is disposed of responsibly. You can use any public litter bin, not just designated dog waste bins, otherwise you should dispose of it in your own general waste bins at home.

Should you witness someone failing to clean up after their dog and you know the owner's details, the Comhairle ask that you report it to them. (01851) 822694

A TRINITY OF FINLAYS

When I became the minister in Bernera 12 years ago I was ably, prayerfully and seriously supported by the elders in the church.

It was easy to remember their names for the three of them had the same name – Fionnlagh or Finlay. This ensured that I could not go too far wrong when trying to remember their names. With the passage of time and the natural change that results from the fragility of human life only one of these dear men now remain with us.

Finlay MacDonald, better known as 'Fionnlagh Tharmoid Dhol' was quite an ebullient character. One, whose conversation invariably took his hearers back to the time when a man called Jesus impacted his life. A lasting transformation of soul, hope and heart that took place during the time of the religious revival of the 1950's.

Finlay MacLennan, better known as 'Fionnlagh Beag Iain a' Mheatsdair 'was small in stature but mighty in prayer. With an ever-present smile and a gamboing gait, Finlay presented a welcome, warm and loving face to the congregation each time they entered the church midweek and Sunday. Finlay's most impressive character trait, or at least one on them, was how little he would comment on others. Always supportive, always prayerful. Finlay incarnated the teaching of James where he says **'So then my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath; for the wrath of man does not produce the righteousness of God', James 1:19 -20**

Sometimes, as with Finlay, one learns more from another person's silence than from many words.. This gracious restraint enables others to be built up in their lives and in their most holy faith in a way that many words cannot.

Which brings us to Finlay MacIver. Better known as 'Fionnlagh Mac Iain Fhionnlagh. A man who appears to be related to more people in Bernera and elsewhere than anyone else I have ever met so I need to be careful what I say. Just really to thank you Finlay for all your service to the Lord's work and to the people of our parish in Bernera down through the years and the decades since you returned from Glasgow.

A trinity of elders, joined together eternally by the love of God Jesus in Bernera and who will one day be reunited in glory through the redeeming, everlasting salvation God provides for us through faith in Jesus, the Great High Priest of our Profession.

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



VIRTUAL SERVICES.

For those of you with access to the internet, Lochs-in-Bernera Church of Scotland offer regular virtual services as listed below.

Online Sunday Service - 10:30 am
(Available on the Church's FB page or Youtube Channel thereafter, further details below.)

Online Sunday School - 12 noon

Online Prayer Meeting - 7 pm each Thursday evening.

Both the online Sunday School and the Prayer Meeting are hosted on video conferencing. They are open to all, please email the Minister at berneralwuig@btinternet.com to receive a secure invitation. Full Safeguarding Protocols are followed in respect of all activities involving children online

The Sunday Service is available on the Church's Facebook page, and from Sunday 17th May from the Church's Youtube Channel, accessible from the Facebook page. If you would like any technical help and support to enable

you to access any of the online services please get in touch with us at The Daily Ceilidh, for free assistance (01851 600 159).

OISEAN A' CHALMAN BANCA PAISDE [DOVE'S WING BABY BANK]

Open to all parents and children residing in Uig, Bernera and Kinloch, through their Facebook page.
24 hr Contact Number – Call or Text 07903 311934 in complete confidence.

PASTORAL CARE

The Minister is available 24/7 to offer pastoral care to anyone in the Parish of Bernera whether or not they come to church.

He may be contacted on: (01851) 672 388 or 07971 057915 or by e-mail at berneralwuig@btinternet.com.

